THE WEEKEND BUILDER / FREE RESOURCE

Is your app idea worth a weekend?

Use evidence to choose one small, reachable problem. An idea score is a prioritisation aid, not proof of demand.

1. Write a problem, not a feature

For [specific person], [repeated situation] causes [cost or frustration]. Today they use [workaround]. My first version helps them [one useful outcome]. Example: a freelance tutor spends 30 minutes each Friday reconciling lesson payments in messages.

2. Score the opportunity from 0 to 2

Frequency: rare (0), monthly (1), weekly or more (2).
Pain: mild annoyance (0), wastes time (1), creates a meaningful cost (2).
Reach: no access (0), a community you can join (1), people you can talk to now (2).
Workaround: none (0), occasional manual work (1), repeated effort or an existing spend (2).
Scope: many systems (0), one substantial workflow (1), one result you can demo in two weekends (2).

3. Talk to five people before you build

Ask about the last time the problem happened. What did they do? How much time did it take? What have they tried? Who decides whether to pay? Ask to see their current workflow with sensitive information removed.

4. Seek a concrete next step

Ask for a short test of a sketch or sample output. A real trial, a scheduled follow-up, or a voluntary purchase can be stronger evidence than a compliment. Avoid treating likes, votes, or imagined willingness to pay as sales.

5. Decide what to do this weekend

Choose the smallest test that removes uncertainty. If you cannot reach users, solve distribution first. If the problem is weak, change the problem. If the scope is too large, demonstrate one useful result manually.

WORKSHEET / IDEA & VALIDATION

Your idea decision sheet

Write down what you heard, including evidence that argues against your idea.

The user and the repeated problem

_____
_____

Their current workaround and its cost

_____
_____

Your smallest useful outcome

_____
_____

Score: frequency __ / pain __ / reach __ / workaround __ / scope __

_____
_____

Five people to contact this week

_____
_____
_____

Evidence for and against building

_____
_____
_____

Your decision

Proceed / narrow the scope / run another test / stop.
My next action: _____ By: _____